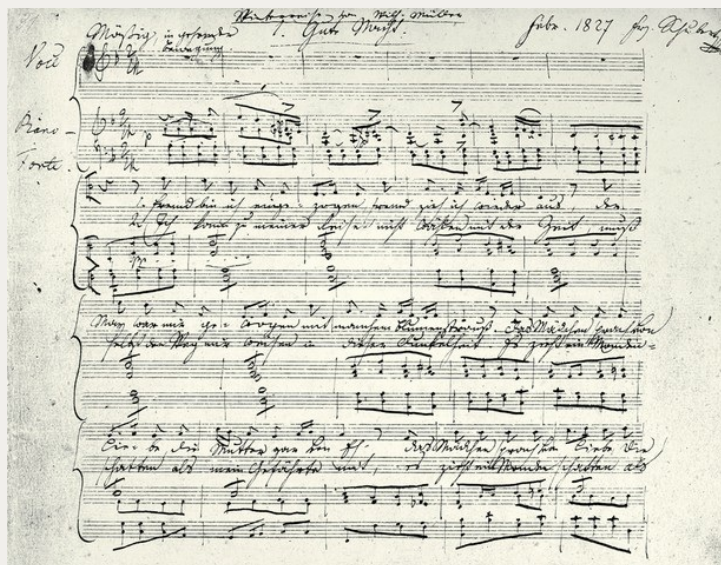


ON TECHNIQUE

Song cycles

A song cycle is a group of individual songs, each capable of standing alone but usually performed together in a fixed order, because they make emotional and dramatic sense as a sequence. Schubert was not the first composer to create cycles of German art songs (known as Lied, plural Lieder), but his masterpieces *Die schöne Müllerin* and *Winterreise* established the genre's major status. Their themes include unrequited love, melancholy, and isolation. Robert Schumann and Gustav Mahler were among the composers who continued the German song-cycle tradition.



AUTOGRAPH SCORE OF "GUTE NACHT" FROM
SCHUBERT'S *WINTERREISE*, 1827

According to some accounts, in around 1814 Schubert fell in love with a young soprano, Therese Grob, a childhood friend. Prevented from